Patient Identification Policy

SHIFA General Hospital (Fictional)

DEMO / SYNTHETIC HOSPITAL DATA — NOT FOR REAL CLINICAL USE

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1. Purpose

Correct patient identification prevents wrong-patient errors in medication, blood transfusion, tests and procedures. This policy applies to all clinical staff. The Patient Safety Office is reachable on extension 1400.

2. The Two-Identifier Rule

Before any care activity, staff must confirm at least two identifiers: (1) the patient's full name and (2) the MRN or the date of birth. Room number, bed number or diagnosis must never be used as an identifier.

Ask the patient to state their own name and date of birth. Do not ask a leading question such as 'Are you Mr Khan?'. If the patient cannot speak, check the wristband and confirm with the attendant.

3. ID Wristbands

- White band: standard identification (name, MRN, date of birth, sex) for every inpatient and every ED patient who is admitted or kept for observation.
- Red band: allergy alert.
- Yellow band: fall risk (see PS-03).
- Purple band: Do Not Resuscitate (DNR) order.

The band is applied before the patient leaves the ED or the Admissions Desk. If a band is missing, unreadable or wrong, stop, verify identity using two identifiers and replace the band immediately.

4. When Identification Must Be Checked

- Before giving any medication.
- Before a blood transfusion.
- Before collecting blood or any other specimen.
- Before any procedure, surgery or radiology test.
- Before transporting the patient to another department.

5. Blood Transfusion and Specimens

A blood transfusion needs two licensed staff members (two nurses, or a nurse and a doctor) to check the patient identity and the blood bag details together at the bedside. Specimen labels are written at the bedside, in front of the patient, straight after collection. Labelling tubes in advance is prohibited.

6. Newborns

Two identical ID bands showing the mother's name, mother's MRN, baby's sex and date and

time of birth are applied before the baby leaves the delivery room: one on the wrist and one on the ankle.

7. Patients With Similar Names

A Name Alert sticker is placed on the chart and the bed board. Where possible, patients with similar names are not placed in the same room.

8. Reporting

Any identification error or near miss must be reported in the incident reporting system within 24 hours.